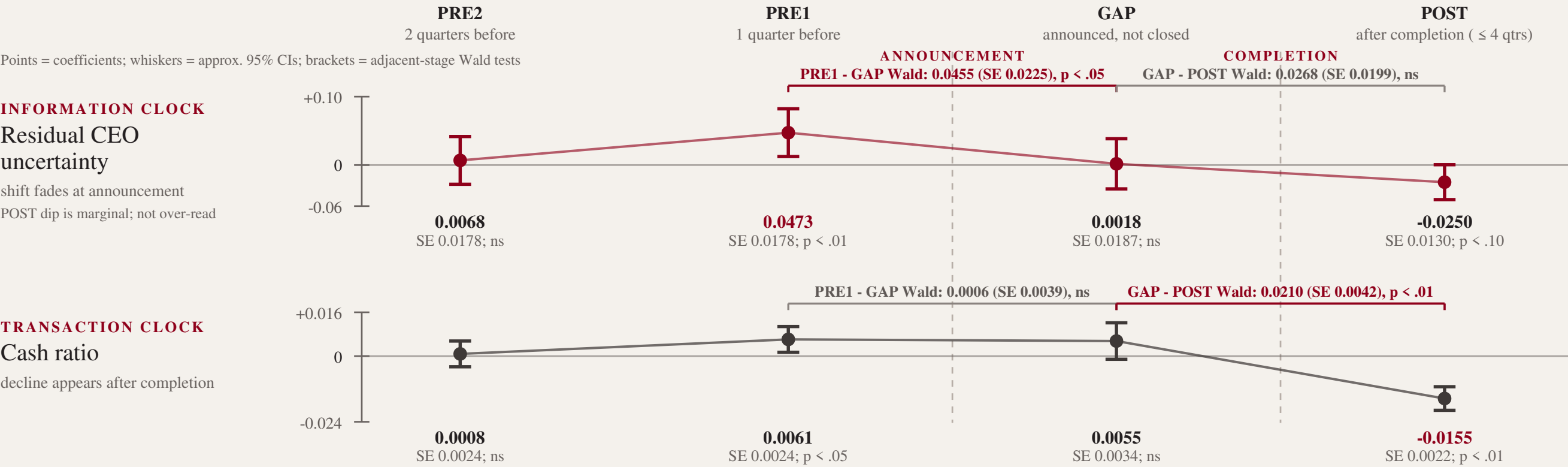


FINDING 2

Announcement vs. Completion

Two clocks: residual uncertainty becomes indistinguishable from baseline **at announcement**; cash falls only **at completion**.

Omitted baseline: $e \leq -3$ (three or more quarters before announcement) plus never-acquirers. Both outcomes use the same matched firm-quarters.



MATCHED SAMPLE 28,102 firm-quarters 1,320 firms; identical rows	CONTROLS AND FIXED EFFECTS Leverage, ln(assets), Tobin's Q, ROA, capex, dividend indicator, cash-flow volatility; firm and calendar year-quarter FE. Cash adds its own lag: 0.7547 (SE 0.0108), $p < .01$.	INFERENCE Firm-clustered SEs; two-tailed tests
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